



Reference section

Mathematical signs and symbols

This table shows a selection of signs and symbols commonly used in mathematics. Using signs and symbols, mathematicians can express complex equations and formulas in a standardized way that is universally understood.

Symbol	Definition	Symbol	Definition	Symbol	Definition
+	plus; positive	:	ratio of (6:4)	∞	infinity
−	minus; negative	::	proportionately equal (1:2::2:4)	n^2	squared number
±	plus or minus; positive or negative; degree of accuracy	$\approx, \doteq, \simeq$	approximately equal to; equivalent to; similar to	n^3	cubed number
∓	minus or plus; negative or positive	$\equiv$	congruent to; identical with	n^4, n^5, etc	power, exponent
×	multiplied by (6×4)	>	greater than	$\sqrt{\quad}$	square root
·	multiplied by (6·4); scalar product of two vectors (A·B)	≫	much greater than	$\sqrt[3]{\quad}, \sqrt[4]{\quad}$	cube root, fourth root, etc.
÷	divided by ($6 \div 4$)	≧	not greater than	%	percent
/	divided by; ratio of ($\frac{6}{4}$)	<	less than	°	degrees (°F); degree of arc, for example 90°
—	divided by; ratio of ($\frac{6}{4}$)	≪	much less than	$\angle, \angle^s$	angle(s)
○	circle	≠	not less than	$\sphericalangle$	equiangular
▲	triangle	≥, ≤, ≡	greater than or equal to	π	(pi) the ratio of the circumference to the diameter of a circle ≈ 3.14
□	square	≤, ≡, ≥	less than or equal to	α	alpha (unknown angle)
▭	rectangle	∞	directly proportional to	θ	theta (unknown angle)
▭	parallelogram	()	parentheses, can mean multiply	⊥	perpendicular
=	equals	−	vinculum: division (a-b); chord of circle or length of line (AB);	⊥	right angle
≠, ≠	not equal to	$\overrightarrow{AB}$	vector	, ≡	parallel
≡	identical with; congruent to	$\overline{AB}$	line segment	∴	therefore
≢, ≠	not identical with	$\overleftrightarrow{AB}$	line	∵	because
△	corresponds to			$\stackrel{m}{=}$	measured by